

Bastrop County Housing Accelerator: mid-term evaluation agreement

Between the Capital Area Housing Council and the Accelerator program office · signed 9 December 2022

Scenario document authored for this exercise. The program, the council and the office are fictional; Bastrop County and the comparison counties are real, and the permit figures referred to are the U.S. Census Bureau's published Building Permits Survey data.

1. The program

The Accelerator waives building-permit fees and guarantees a fifteen-working-day plan review for new homes in Bastrop County, Texas. It began on 1 January 2023. Its first term ends on 31 December 2026.

2. What the council measures

The council measures new housing as the housing units authorized by building permits, all structure sizes together, issued by the permit offices in each county, taken from the Census Bureau's Building Permits Survey annual files.

3. Comparison

Bastrop County is compared with the other four counties of the Austin–Round Rock–San Marcos metro area (Caldwell, Hays, Travis and Williamson), taken together as one area.

4. Growth

An area's growth is the change from the average of its 2021 and 2022 units (the base years) to the average of its 2023 and 2024 units (the program years), expressed as a percentage of the base-year average.

5. Effect

The effect is Bastrop County's growth less the comparison area's growth, in percentage points.

6. Pre-launch check

Bastrop County's percentage change from 2021 to 2022, less the comparison area's percentage change from 2021 to 2022, must lie within 40 points of zero. If it does not, the two areas were not moving together before the program began and the council cannot credit the program with any effect.

7. Decision

If the pre-launch check holds and the effect is at least 20 percentage points, the council funds a second term, 1 January 2027 to 31 December 2029. Otherwise the program ends on 31 December 2026. The effect and the check are compared with these thresholds before any rounding.

Signed for the council: D. Ramirez, chair · Signed for the program office: K. Osei, director